# LabTrack user guide for researchers

## Applicable from version: LabTrack v0.3.0.1

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For people who use LabTrack with the researcher role in Calira. Lab admins should read the LabTrack installation and configuration guide.

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# What LabTrack does

LabTrack runs on the PC connected to a shared instrument. It keeps the PC locked until you log in with your Calira account. It then records when your session starts and when it ends.

Your lab admin uses these times to compare actual use of the instrument with booked use in Calira. This helps the lab plan bookings, maintenance and equipment spend.

LabTrack records the start and end times of your session. It does not record what you do on the PC.

## What you need

- A Calira account with access to the lab that owns the instrument.
- Your sign-in details: your Calira email and password, or your organisation's single sign-on.
- A confirmed booking on the instrument, if your lab requires one. The next section explains how to tell.

# How your lab has set up the instrument

Your lab admin chooses one of two set-ups when installing LabTrack on the PC. If the log-in screen says **This instrument requires a booking to use**, the instrument requires a booking.

| | **Booking required** | **No booking required** |
|---|---|---|
| Before you log in | You need a confirmed booking made by you on this instrument. It must be running now or start within the unlock window (15 minutes by default). | You do not need anything. You can log in at any time. |
| If you have no booking | You see an error and the PC stays locked. | You can still log in. LabTrack records a session with no booking. |
| If you have a booking | LabTrack links your session to the booking. | LabTrack links your session to the booking. |
| How a session ends | You end it, or LabTrack ends it automatically after your booking finishes. | You end it, or LabTrack ends it automatically after a default session length. |

Defaults shown are the standard LabTrack settings. Your lab admin can change them for each instrument.

## Start a session

1. Go to the PC next to the instrument. LabTrack covers the whole screen with a log-in window.

*[Screenshot 1] The full-screen log-in screen with the Email and Password fields, the "Login via your organisation" link and the Log in button. Use an instrument that requires a booking so the line "This instrument requires a booking to use." is visible.*

2. Enter your Calira email and password, then select **Log in**.
3. If your organisation uses single sign-on, select **Login via your organisation** instead. Sign in on your organisation's page inside the LabTrack window. Select **Cancel** to go back to the log-in form.

*[Screenshot 2] The single sign-on view showing the organisation's sign-in page and the Cancel button.*

4. LabTrack checks your bookings for this instrument. If you pass the check, the full-screen window shrinks to a small panel at the bottom right of the screen and the Windows desktop becomes available.
5. Use the instrument as normal.

**The locked screen**
While LabTrack is locked, the Windows key, Alt+Tab, Alt+F4 and Ctrl+Esc do not work. Any other monitors on the PC show only the Calira logo. This is intentional. Everything works again once you have logged in.

### Booking rules at log-in

- The booking must be made by you, on this instrument, and be confirmed. A booking that is still waiting for admin approval does not unlock the instrument.
- You can log in up to 15 minutes before your booking starts (the unlock window). Your lab admin can change this window.
- LabTrack records your actual start as the moment you log in, even if that is before your booking starts.
- If more than one of your bookings falls inside the window, LabTrack uses the one running now. If none is running, it uses the next one to start.

*[Screenshot 3] The error shown when you have no booking: "There are no bookings associated with this account starting in the next 15 minutes."*

## During your session

The panel at the bottom right of the screen shows how your session is going.

*[Screenshot 4] The session panel with the greeting, the “In progress” status, Booked time, Actual time, Next booking and the End session button. Include the minimise button at the top.*

| Item | What it shows |
|---|---|
| Status | The state of your session: In progress, Upcoming booking or Booking finished. See the table below. |
| Booked time | The start and end time of your booking. It does not appear if you have no booking. |
| Actual time | When you logged in and the current time. It updates every second. |
| Next booking | When the next booking on this instrument starts, for example “in 25 minutes”. It shows N/A if nothing is booked after yours. The next booking can belong to anyone. |

## Status messages

| Status | What it means | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| In progress | Your session is running. The next booking is more than 5 minutes away, or there is none. | Carry on. |
| Upcoming booking | The next booking starts within 5 minutes. The panel comes to the front of the screen. | Finish up and end your session before the next booking starts. |
| Booking finished | The next booking has reached its start time. The panel comes to the front of the screen. | End your session now. |

*[Screenshot 5] The panel showing “Upcoming booking” and then “Booking finished”, with the Next booking line highlighted.*

These two messages only appear when someone has booked the instrument after your booking. If nothing follows, the panel shows In progress until you end the session or LabTrack ends it.

## Hide and show the panel

Select the minimise button at the top of the panel to hide it. LabTrack keeps running and keeps timing your session.

To bring the panel back, double-click the LabTrack icon in the notification area at the right of the Windows taskbar. You can also right-click the icon and choose **Show**. In this version the icon's tooltip still reads "Clustermarket LabTrack".

*[Screenshot 6] The Windows notification area with the LabTrack icon, and its right-click menu showing Show.*

## End your session

1. Save your work and close any files you do not want the next person to see.
2. Open the LabTrack panel. If it is hidden, use the notification area icon.
3. Select **End session**.

LabTrack records your end time and returns to the full-screen log-in window. The PC is now ready for the next person.

> **Always end your session before you leave**
> If you walk away without ending your session, LabTrack keeps counting time on the instrument until the session ends automatically. Your recorded use will be longer than your actual use.
> If automatic end is switched off for your instrument, the session stays open and the next person has to end it before they can log in.

## Automatic log out

LabTrack can end a session for you if you forget. Your lab admin chooses whether this is on and how long it waits. It applies to researchers. Lab admins are not logged out automatically.

### When your lab requires a booking

LabTrack ends your session a set time after your booking ends. The default is 15 minutes after the end time. LabTrack counts from the end of the booking, not from when you logged in.

Example: your booking runs from 10:00 to 12:00 and the default applies. LabTrack shows a warning at 12:10 and ends your session at 12:15.

### When your lab does not require a booking

If you log in without a booking, LabTrack ends your session after a default session length. The default is 60 minutes from the moment you log in. If you log in with a booking, the booking rule above applies.

### The 5-minute warning

Five minutes before the session ends, a small window called **Session will end soon** appears at the bottom left of the screen. It says "You have 5 minutes left".

*[Screenshot 7] The "Session will end soon" window with the Delay by field set to 15 minutes, and the Cancel and Delay buttons.*

- **Delay** adds the minutes you choose to the time left. The default is 15 minutes. You can choose from 0 to 60 minutes in steps of 5. A new warning appears 5 minutes before the new end time. You can delay more than once.
- **Cancel** only closes the warning. It does not cancel the automatic log out.
- Delaying does not change your booking in Calira and does not reserve the instrument. The extra time counts as time on the instrument. If someone has booked after you, end your session instead.

### What happens when the session ends automatically

- LabTrack records the end time and returns to the full-screen log-in window.
- LabTrack does not save files or close programs. Anything you left open stays open on the PC behind the log-in window, so save your work before the warning runs out.

## If the connection drops or the PC switches off

- You need a connection to Calira to log in.
- While your session runs, LabTrack sends an updated end time to Calira about once a minute. If the PC loses power or crashes, Calira keeps the last time it received.
- If LabTrack cannot reach Calira when your session ends, it saves the end time on the PC and sends it the next time someone logs in.
- If you end your session and log in again during the same booking, Calira keeps your first start time and updates the end time. Sessions without a booking are recorded as separate sessions.

## If something goes wrong

| What you see | Likely cause | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| "There are no bookings associated with this account starting in the next 15 minutes." | You have no confirmed booking on this instrument, made by you, inside the unlock window. | In Calira, check that the booking exists, is confirmed and is on this instrument.<br>Check you logged in with the same account you booked with.<br>Try again when your booking is inside the unlock window. |

| What you see | Likely cause | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| An error above the log-in form | Wrong email or password, or your account cannot access this lab. | Check your details.<br>If your organisation uses single sign-on, select “Login via your organisation”.<br>Ask your lab admin to check your access. |
| The panel has disappeared | The panel is minimised. | Double-click the LabTrack icon in the notification area. |
| “Session will end soon” | LabTrack will end your session in 5 minutes. | Save your work and end the session, or select Delay. See Automatic log out. |
| “Update available” | A newer version of LabTrack exists. | Select Cancel and tell your lab admin. Lab admins update LabTrack. |
| “Equipment deleted. Application reset required.” | The instrument was removed from Calira. | Tell your lab admin. A lab admin needs to set the PC up again. |
| Times that do not match your clock | LabTrack uses the PC’s clock and time zone. | Tell your lab admin. |
| Other monitors show only the Calira logo | LabTrack is locked. | Nothing. They clear when you log in. |

## Getting help

Ask your lab admin first. They can check your booking, your access to the instrument and how the PC is set up.

If your lab admin cannot fix it, contact Calira support. Tell them the instrument name, the time it happened and the exact message on the screen. A photo of the screen helps.

### Before you walk away

1. Save your work.
2. Select **End session**.
3. Check that the screen has returned to the log-in window.